> corresponding to existing provinces, in others perhaps modified in area according to the character and economic interests of their people. Over this congeries of States would preside a central Government, increasingly representative of and responsible to the people of all of them; dealing with matters, both internal and external, of common interest to the whole of India; acting as arbiter in inter-state relations; and representing the interests of all India *on equal terms with the self-governing units of the British Empire.* In this picture there is a place also for the Native States (Princely States). It is possible that they too will wish to be associated for certain purposes with the organization of British India in such a way as to dedicate their peculiar qualities to the common service without loss of individuality [emphasis added].

The sanctimony of the British coloniser, his concern for the 'European community' and his expectation of gratitude from Indians for 'India's material prosperity', which is *owed* to Europeans, is captured brilliantly in Paragraph 344 of the Report, extracted as follows:

> (iv) THE NON-OFFICIAL COMMUNITY.
>
> The European commercial community
>
> 344. We cannot conclude without taking into due account the presence of a considerable community of non-official Europeans in India. In the main, they are engaged in commercial enterprises; but besides these are *the missions, European and American, which in furthering education, building up character and inculcating healthier domestic habits have done work for which India should be grateful.* There are also an appreciable number of retired Officials and others whose working life has been given to India, settled in the cooler parts of the country. *When complaints are rife that European commercial interests are selfish and drain the country of wealth which it ought to retain, it is well to remind ourselves how much of, India's material prosperity is due to European commerce.* It is true that those engaged in commerce mix less than officials with educated Indians, and that may be a reason why the latter do not always recognize their claim on India's consideration. Like commercial people all the world over Englishmen in business in India are frankly uninterested in politics; many of them would readily admit that they have taken insufficient